

R is free and open source, like Python. It follows the terms of the Free Software foundation under the GNU license agreement. This means that you have full access to the source code to study how programs work, adapt them your own needs, and share your improvements with other people on sites like GitHub. This has led to the formation of an active R developer community, including a



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R version 3.1.0 (2014-04-10) -- "Spring Dance"
Copyright (C) 2014 The R Foundation for Statistical Computing
Platform: x86_64-apple-darwin10.8.0 (64-bit)

R is free software and comes with ABSOLUTELY NO WARRANTY.
You are welcome to redistribute it under certain conditions.
Type 'license()' or 'licence()' for distribution details.

Natural language support but running in an English locale

R is a collaborative project with many contributors.
Type 'contributors()' for more information and
'citation()' on how to cite R or R packages in publications.

Type 'demo()' for some demos, 'help()' for on-line help, or
'help.start()' for an HTML browser interface to help.
Type 'q()' to quit R.

[R.app GUI 1.63 (6734) x86_64-apple-darwin10.8.0]
[Workspace restored from /Users/danieldmello/.RData]
[History restored from /Users/danieldmello/.Rapp.history]
> |
```

The default R language download is very basic.

core group of 20 developers who, beginning in 1997, keep releasing updates to R every year, and provide feedback on packages you submit to the group.

Packages are programs stored in script files that can run automatically without any additional coding. There are 4000 packages available on the R website at the moment, though some of these are for extremely specialised use and may only benefit one particular community, like people who sequence genomes. Whatever you need, chances are there is a package for it. The packages on the R website go through a quality control process by the core group, but you can always write your own package for personal use and share it online for others to use.

Why is R so important today?

R has applications in healthcare, pharmaceuticals, biochemistry, genetics, molecular biology, computer science, AI and the social sciences. It has packages for almost anything an analyst needs.

Healthcare and pharmaceutical professionals can use R to model the efficacy of drug treatments, biologists can compare and contrast genomes and therapies, social scientists can use it to model behaviour, computer scientists can use it to build better predictive algorithms, and business researchers can use it to model marketing, finance, HR and operations data to help find patterns in data and help businesses.